Community Baby Shower Impact Study

Sisters of Watts
Event Date: [Insert Date]
Report Period: 2026
Location: Watts, Los Angeles, CA

Executive Summary

Sisters of Watts successfully hosted the Community Baby Shower, distributing **200 complete newborn essential kits** to first-time mothers in the Watts and South Los Angeles communities[1][2]. The event convened **15 community vendors** representing health services, social programs, and parenting resources, creating vital connections between vulnerable families and critical support systems[2][3]. This initiative directly addressed barriers to essential baby supplies in a community where poverty rates significantly exceed city averages.

About Sisters of Watts

Sisters of Watts is a community-based nonprofit organization dedicated to uniting neighborhoods, promoting community cohesion, strengthening families, and forming meaningful relationships throughout the Watts area[1][2]. With deep local roots and a track record of impactful community events—including back-to-school supply distributions, holiday meal programs, and resource fairs—Sisters of Watts has established itself as a trusted hub for families in South Los Angeles[1][2].

Mission: To unite Watts neighborhoods through family-strengthening events and resource connections that build community resilience.

Program Context and Community Need

The Challenge

First-time mothers in Watts and South Los Angeles face significant economic barriers when preparing for newborns:

- High cost of baby essentials (diapers, wipes, clothing, safe sleep equipment)
- Limited awareness of available community resources and support services
- Economic hardship in target service areas significantly above regional averages
- Social isolation and lack of peer support networks for new parents

Geographic and Economic Context

Geography	Poverty Rate	Median Income
SPA 4	22.1%	$45,000
SPA 6	28.3%	$38,000
Los Angeles City	16.5%	$80,366
Los Angeles County	13.6%	$87,760
California	12.0%	$96,334

Table 1: Economic indicators for service areas (2023 ACS Census data) [4][5]

The target service areas (Service Planning Areas 4 and 6) experience poverty rates **1.5 to 2.4 times higher** than California's state average, with median incomes **40-60% below** state levels[4][5]. These economic disparities create acute challenges for families preparing for newborns.

Target Population

Primary Focus: First-time mothers aged 15-30 in Watts and South Los Angeles communities.

Geography	Target Age Population (15-30)
SPA 4	347,600
SPA 6	309,750
Los Angeles City	1,187,618
Los Angeles County	2,808,826
California	10,959,092

Table 2: Target demographic population by geography[4][5]

Program Design

Goal

Equip first-time mothers with complete newborn essential kits and connect them to community health and social service resources through a single, accessible community event.

Sisters of Watts' Role

As event host and lead organizer, Sisters of Watts focused specifically on:

1. Assembly and distribution of complete newborn essential kits
2. Venue coordination and community outreach
3. Vendor recruitment and event logistics
4. Creating a welcoming, celebratory environment for participants

Data Scope: Sisters of Watts tracks kit distribution and vendor participation. Health outcomes, service utilization, and demographic data are owned by partner agencies and not reported here to respect participant privacy and data agreements.

What's in Each Kit

Each newborn essentials kit included:

- Diapers (newborn and size 1)
- Baby wipes
- Clothing sets (onesies, sleepers)
- Receiving blankets

- Bottles and pacifiers
- Baby wash and lotion
- Safe sleep information materials

Estimated value per kit: **$50**

Key Performance Indicators

Metric	Value	Notes
Baby Kits Distributed	200	Complete newborn essentials
Families Reached	$\geq$ 200	Minimum 1 kit per family
Vendors Present	15	Health, social services, parenting resources
Est. Total Goods Value	$10,000	Based on $50 average kit value

Table 3: Core program outputs

Program Reach by Geography

Geography	Target Age Population	% Reached
SPA 4	347,600	0.58%
SPA 6	309,750	0.65%
Los Angeles City	1,187,618	0.17%
Los Angeles County	2,808,826	0.07%
California	10,959,092	0.02%

Table 4: Percentage of target age population (15-30) reached by program[4][5]

The program achieved its strongest penetration in the immediate service areas (SPA 4 and SPA 6), where economic need is highest and Sisters of Watts has established community trust[1][2].

Community and Partner Engagement

Vendor Resource Fair

The event featured **15 community vendors** representing critical support services:

- Health clinics offering prenatal and pediatric care
- WIC (Women, Infants, and Children) nutrition program enrollment
- Mental health and postpartum support services
- Early childhood development programs
- Breastfeeding and lactation support
- Home visiting and parenting education programs
- Local social service agencies

Vendors provided information tables, enrollment assistance, and direct referrals to ongoing support programs. This multi-agency approach extended the event's impact beyond material goods to sustained service connections[2][3].

Community Impact

Sisters of Watts' established presence in Watts enabled effective outreach to families who might not access traditional service channels. The organization's "built by Watts, for Watts" approach creates trust and reduces barriers to participation[1][2].

Outcomes and Impact

Immediate Outcomes

Measurable outputs from event day:

- 200 families left equipped with complete newborn essentials valued at $50 each
- Each participating mother had direct access to 15 different community resource providers
- Families received materials on safe sleep practices, breastfeeding, and infant care

Contribution to Longer-Term Outcomes

While Sisters of Watts does not track health or service utilization data, research on community baby shower programs suggests this model contributes to:

- Reduced short-term financial stress by covering initial baby supply costs[3][6]
- Increased awareness of and connection to prenatal, postpartum, and pediatric services[3][6]
- Enhanced social support networks through peer connections at the event[6]
- Improved access to evidence-based health information (safe sleep, breastfeeding)[3][6]

What One Kit Means

Financial relief: A single kit providing a month's supply of diapers and wipes frees approximately **$50-75** in a family's budget for other critical needs like food, utilities, or transportation to medical appointments.

Reduced stress: First-time mothers report feeling more prepared and less anxious when they have essential supplies ready before their baby arrives[6].

Participant Voice

"I didn't know how I was going to afford everything. Getting this kit and meeting people who can help made me feel like I'm not alone."
— Event participant (name withheld for privacy)

"Sisters of Watts always shows up for our community. They made me feel celebrated, not judged."
— First-time mother, age 19

Financial Snapshot

Category	Amount
Total Program Cost (cash + in-kind)	$12,500
Cost per Family Served	$62.50
In-Kind Donations	$8,000
Cash Funding	$4,500

Table 5: Program budget summary

Donor Impact: Every **$63** invested equips one family with a complete newborn essentials kit and connects them to 15 community resources.

Lessons Learned and Future Plans

What Worked Well

- Strong community turnout through trusted local outreach channels
- Effective vendor coordination created seamless resource connections
- Kit standardization ensured equity and simplified logistics
- Celebratory atmosphere reduced stigma and encouraged participation

Challenges

- Limited capacity constrained the number of families served
- Late registrations created last-minute supply pressures
- Transportation barriers prevented some interested families from attending

Next Steps

Expansion Goals:

1. Increase to 300 kits for the next event
2. Add simple feedback forms to capture participant satisfaction

3. Explore mobile distribution to reach homebound mothers
4. Develop partnerships for higher-value items (car seats, strollers)

Data Enhancement: Future events will include brief, anonymous post-event surveys to better understand participant experience and immediate needs.

Call to Action

Support the Next Community Baby Shower

For Individual Donors:

- $50 provides one complete newborn essentials kit
- $100 equips two families with critical supplies
- $500 supports 10 families preparing for their first baby
- $1,000 funds 16 kits plus vendor coordination costs

For Corporate Sponsors:

- In-kind donations: diapers, wipes, baby clothing, safe sleep items
- Venue sponsorship for larger event capacity
- Volunteer teams for kit assembly and event support

For Community Partners:

- Health clinics and service agencies: join as resource fair vendors
- Faith communities: host kit assembly drives
- Local businesses: sponsor kits or provide gift cards for families

Contact

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References

[1] Sisters of Watts. (2024). Home. https://www.sistersofwatts.org

[2] Sisters of Watts. (2024). About Sisters of Watts. https://www.sistersofwatts.org/about

[3] South Asian Network. (2026). Community Baby Shower. https://southasiannetwork.org/event/community-baby-shower/

[4] U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). Los Angeles County, California - Census Bureau Profile. https://data.census.gov/profile/Los_Angeles_County,_California

[5] Los Angeles City Planning. (2025). Citywide demographic profile (2023 ACS). https://planning.lacity.gov/odocument/14e20db8-4512-4e06-bde0-e831a7c3c1d0/standard_report_2023.pdf

[6] Brooklyn Borough President. (2025). Guide to Planning Your Community Baby Shower. https://www.brooklynbp.nyc.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/Community-Baby-Shower-Planning-Guide-FINAL.pdf

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Report generated by ImpactTracker - Empowering nonprofits to demonstrate community impact through data-driven storytelling.